

4) Privacy settings on apps and social media

Reviewing privacy policies and permissions

Understanding how your data is used is crucial in today's modern digital age, whether it's all the apps you have installed and use on your phone or the various social platforms you spend time on a daily basis.

Understanding data permissions on apps

Apps often request access to personal data or device functions. Only grant permissions that are necessary for the app's functionality. Be cautious with apps that ask for excessive permissions.

What to focus on in privacy policies

- Look for sections on data collection, usage, and sharing.
- Focus on how your data is stored and protected.
- Check if the app shares data with third parties.

Privacy practices of popular apps

Familiarise yourself with the privacy settings of apps you frequently use. Some apps may collect more data than necessary, so adjust settings to limit data sharing.

Adjusting privacy settings on key platforms

One of the tenets of cybersecurity posture is to control who sees your information, and to constantly review this from time to time.

Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter privacy guides

- **Facebook:** Use the Privacy Checkup tool to adjust who can see your posts, profile information, and manage data settings.
- **Instagram:** Set your account to private, control story sharing, and manage comment settings.
- **Twitter:** Protect your tweets, manage discoverability, and control direct message settings.

Location sharing and ad preferences

- Disable location services for apps that don't require it.
- Adjust ad preferences to limit personalised ads based on your activity.

Third-Party apps and data access

Regularly review and revoke access for third-party apps that are no longer in use or that you don't trust.

Risks of third-party data sharing

Sharing data with third-party apps increases the risk of data breaches and misuse.

Recognizing and limiting third-party access

- Go to your account settings on social platforms to see which apps have access.

- Revoke permissions for unnecessary or suspicious apps.
- Be cautious when granting new permissions.

Using app permission audits

Use available tools to audit app permissions regularly. This helps you stay aware of who has access to your data and ensures that only trusted apps are connected.

5) Securing IoT devices at home

Common security risks of IoT devices

IoT devices can be entry points for cyber attacks in ways that are easy to overlook in most cases, therefore it's important to pay attention to them in your cybersecurity strategy.

Privacy risks of smart TVs, cameras, and speakers

These devices may collect personal data, audio, or video without explicit consent. Unauthorised access can lead to eavesdropping or surveillance.

Data collection by IoT manufacturers

Manufacturers may gather data for analytics or marketing purposes. Review their privacy policies to understand what data is collected and how it's used.

Setting up a secure network

Protecting your home network is essential, and it begins at the fundamental level with a secure network that can help you by a long way.

Isolating IoT on a guest network

Set up a separate guest Wi-Fi network for your IoT devices. This limits access to your main network, reducing the risk if an IoT device is compromised.

Enabling WPA3 encryption

Use the latest Wi-Fi security protocol, WPA3, to encrypt your network. Check your router's settings to enable this feature, enhancing protection against unauthorised access.

Routine IoT device audits

Regular maintenance keeps devices secure.

Firmware updates and password changes

- Regularly update device firmware to patch security vulnerabilities.
- Change default passwords to strong, unique ones to prevent unauthorised access.

Disabling unused features and ports

- Turn off features you don't use, like remote access or microphones.
- Close unnecessary ports to reduce potential entry points for attackers. 🚫